1. The UN Security Council enacted Resolution 1701 to disarm Hezbollah. Even if it is not implemented, it greatly improves Israel's position. This is also true regarding the supply of new weapons from Syria, Iran, or any other source. Hezbollah continues to break the cease-fire agreement, and so do we, though we attack them in their territories in Lebanon and Syria.
2. For the first time, the Lebanese army was deployed along the international border between Israel and Lebanon, and the IDF was redeployed along the border fence on our side.
3. The UN international force grew and received more "teeth."
4. The two forces—the Lebanese army and the UN force—serve as a physical buffer between us and Hezbollah, which was not the case beforehand.
5. Syria's status and influence in Lebanon were weakened.
6. A bloc of moderate Arab states openly opposed to radical Muslim forces began to develop.

So what's next? In order to assess future trends, one must first examine the state of the players in the Second Lebanon War today, in 2017, the time of the writing of this book. *Iran* has signed the nuclear agreement with the United States, and the sanctions against it are gradually being lifted. Iran and the United States are cooperating, de facto, in the war against ISIS in Iraq. Iran and Syria continue to equip Hezbollah with weapons; the IDF thwarted this supply militarily in March 2017 and declared that it would continue to do so whenever conditions and intelligence allow it.

Hezbollah as a guerrilla organization has sunk deep into the Syrian swamp and is taking losses of strategic magnitude for an organization of its size. The organization's standing among the Lebanese public is at an all-time low. *Syria* has been embroiled in a civil war for several years, with ISIS having seized large parts of the country bordering Iraq, and various opposition groups threatening Bashar Assad's regime, which survives only because of the support of Putin, who has established a new reality in the region—the permanent presence of Russian air, sea, and land forces in Syria.